

ASHIMA KAUSHIK

Communication & Visual Designer

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SUMMARY

Communication and visual designer with experience spanning brand identity, environmental graphics, editorial design and design research. Skilled at translating user and stakeholder insights into cohesive visual systems, having delivered brand guidelines across 83 airports, led an end-to-end rebrand for a national gas distribution company, and developed a 110+ letterform Devanagari typeface rooted in folk art. Comfortable moving between strategic proposal decks, hands-on typography and illustration, and facilitating cross-functional design thinking workshops.

SKILLS

Design: Brand Identity, Brand Extension, Visual Communication, Typography, Logo Design, Editorial Design, Book Design, Environmental Graphics, Vector Illustration, Print Production, Conceptualisation

Research & Strategy: Design Research, User Research (Remote & Field Studies), Usability Testing, Design Thinking, Customer Experience, Storytelling & Narrative, Facilitating Workshops

TOOLS

Adobe Illustrator, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe InDesign, Figma, Miro, Glyphs, MS Office

EXPERIENCE

Designer

Tata Elxsi, Bengaluru | Jul 2023 – Feb 2025

- Extended Air India's brand identity across 83 airports globally, designing boarding passes, customer experience touchpoints and brand guidelines for consistent implementation.
- Led end-to-end rebranding for a leading Indian natural gas distribution company, developing brand strategy and identity guidelines.
- Developed strategic proposal decks that translated user research and stakeholder insights into design solutions aligned with business objectives.
- Designed user journeys and environmental graphics for corporate experience centers used to host clients, investors and leadership, strengthening brand presence in high-stakes, invite-only environments.
- Archived, dated and sorted approximately 10,000 artifacts as part of a cross-functional team curating and designing a virtual museum for a leading aviation company.
- Facilitated 7+ design thinking workshops with cross-functional teams to drive collaborative problem-solving.
- Partnered with print production vendors to achieve 100% accuracy across print deliverables.

Freelance Designer

Self-Employed | Jan 2023 – Present

- Designed logos, editorial layouts and brand identity extensions — posters, hoardings, brochures, social media content and ID cards — across print and digital applications for independent clients.
- Refined layouts across 250 pages for "The Great Himalayan Exploration" (Royal Enfield) — adjusting compositions, imagery placement and captions — based on Ishan Khosla's design direction.

Junior Visual Designer

Ishan Khosla Design Studio, Dehradun | Jun 2022 – Jan 2023

- Digitized a highly illustrative Devanagari typeface comprising 110+ letterforms based on folk art, leading a team of 6 interns and improving project efficiency by 30% while ensuring on-time delivery.

- Maintained composition, text and colour consistency and finalized captions across 175 pages for "Convergence" (commissioned by Institut Français en Inde, published by the Alkazi Foundation), based on Ishan Khosla's design direction.
- Designed book covers and editorial layouts for clients including HarperCollins and the Alkazi Foundation.

Graduation Project Intern

The Typecraft Initiative / Jan 2022 – May 2022

- Created typographic illustrations for a Hindi-language teaching aid, connecting language learning with cultural storytelling.
- Organized design methodology workshops bringing together folk artists, vernacular experts and designers.
- Directed the design process end-to-end, from concept through execution, using remote and field user research and usability testing to shape pedagogical outcomes.

Product Development Intern

SEWA (Self Employed Women's Association), NGO / Jul 2021 – Sep 2021

- Designed 15 hand-stitched, embroidered products in collaboration with artisans specializing in Gujarati appliqué and embroidery, aligning designs with market trends and consumer preferences.

Design Intern

Centre for Public Policy and Good Governance, Uttarakhand / Jun 2020 – Jul 2020

- Collaborated with a team to design posters and merchandise promoting the UN Sustainable Development Goals for the Government of Uttarakhand.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Design (B.Des), Visual Communication & Media

UPES, Dehradun / 2018 – 2022

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

Typoday 2022 – Contributed research to "Akshar-Chitra," an academic paper on folk-art-based type as a visual mnemonic for teaching Hindi (research credited under Ishan Khosla).

Toycathon 2021 – Selected for the Grand Finale for research, conceptualization and visual identity design of a board game for sighted and visually impaired players.

CERTIFICATIONS

Google, 2023 – Foundations of UX Design; UX Design Process; Build Wireframes and Prototypes

Museum of Modern Art, 2020 – Modern Art and Ideas; Art and Activity: Interactive Strategies for Engaging with Art